

Minimum Pledgeship Requirements

Sigma Omega Nu, Latina Interest Sorority, Inc.

Each Little Sister must meet and maintain all minimum membership requirements throughout the length of the Big Sister Little Sister process. Failure to maintain these requirements throughout the Big Sister Little Sister process will result in relief of duties and obligations as a Little Sister of Sigma Omega Nu.

1. Grade Point Average and Progress Reports

- a. Little Sisters must maintain a minimum 2.3 quarter/semester GPA, a minimum 2.5 cumulative GPA and be in Good Academic Standing with the University and cannot be on probation of any kind.
- b. Little Sisters must submit Progress Reports for all classes by the designated deadline. Each Progress Report form must be completed by the professor or instructor, indicating your current grade in the class.

2. Sober Pledgeship and Alcohol/Drug Policy

- a. All Little Sisters under the age of 21 are required to maintain a sober pledgeship throughout the entire Big Sister Little Sister process, in accordance with federal and state laws regarding the legal drinking age. This means that Little Sisters under the age of 21 are strictly prohibited from consuming alcoholic beverages or using illegal drugs that are not prescribed by a licensed medical professional.
- b. Little Sisters who are 21 or older are likewise prohibited from using illegal drugs that are not prescribed by a licensed medical professional. While those 21 and older may legally consume alcohol outside of sorority obligations, they are encouraged to maintain a commitment to sobriety throughout the process in support of a respectful pledgeship experience.
- c. To uphold a respectful and responsibility environment, Little Sisters are expected to be fully sober for at least four (4) hours prior to any meeting, event or activity, including but not limited to study hours, fundraisers, and community service events. This ensures that all participants can engage with clarity, focus, and mutual respect. This standard is similar to what would be expected in a professional or academic setting, just as one would not attend a class or workplace obligation while under the influence, the same applies to the process.
- d. Use of prescription medication, as directed by a licensed medical provider, and over-the-counter medications, taken according to labeled dosing instructions, is permitted.
- e. While Little Sisters are not prohibited from being in environments where alcohol or drugs may be present, they are expected to demonstrate sound judgement.

3. Little Sister Pin

- a. Little Sisters are encouraged, but not required, to wear their Little Sister Pin to weekly meetings during the process.

4. Attendance

- a. Little Sisters are allowed a maximum of three (3) unexcused absences from meetings or activities throughout the Big Sister Little Sister process. The Pledge Mother(s) will inform you which meetings and activities count toward this.
- b. To request an excused absence, the Little Sister must submit a written letter to the Pledge Mother(s) at least 24 hours in advance to the event. The letter will be read aloud at the next meeting with the Pledge Mother(s), and the Pledge Class will vote to approve or deny the request. A majority vote is required to excuse the absence.
- c. In the event of an emergency, the Little Sister must notify the Pledge Mother(s) as soon as possible. A written letter explaining the situation must be submitted within seven days of the absence for consideration.

5. Use of Greek Letters and Organizational Representation

- a. Little Sisters are not allowed to wear the Greek Letters of Sigma Omega Nu ($\Sigma\Omega\Nu$) together in that order, as doing so signifies full membership in the organization. Wearing the Greek Letters represents a formal connection to our sisterhood, commitment to its mission, and adherence to the standards expected of initiated members. As such, only fully initiated members may wear or use the Greek Letters $\Sigma\Omega\Nu$ to identify themselves with the organization.
- b. Little Sisters may wear paraphernalia that has Sigma Omega Nu written out or abbreviated as S.O.N., as long as the item also clearly includes identifying terms such as “Little Sister” or “Pledge Class” adjacent to the name. This ensures clarity that the wearer is a Prospective New Member currently in the Big Sister Little Sister process.
- c. Little Sisters may not write or use the Official Greek Letters of $\Sigma\Omega\Nu$ on any personal items, such as binders, clothing, or social media, unless specifically instructed to do so by the Pledge Mother(s).

6. Binder

- a. Each Little Sister will be issued a binder, which must be brought to every meeting and kept confidential. The binder will contain all materials and information provided by the Pledge Mother(s). The binder and its contents are confidential and are not to be shared or shown to anyone outside of Sigma Omega Nu. When not in use, it should be stored in a secure location where non-members cannot access it.

7. Community Service

- a. All Little Sisters are required to complete a minimum of 5 hours of community service by the conclusion of the Big Sister Little Sister process. Of the required 5 hours, at least 2 hours must be complete collectively as a Pledge Class at a single event or through a coordinated service project.

8. Study Hours

- a. To support academic success during the Big Sister Little Sister process, each Little Sister is required to complete a minimum of four study hours per week. Study hours must be completed in groups of at least two Little Sisters to encourage peer support and accountability. Study hours may take place on campus (for example, university library, study lounges, etc.), or at a pre-approved off-campus location such as a public library, coffee shop, or another designated study-friendly environment. These hours are to be used exclusively for academic coursework, including reading, assignments, studying for exams, and group class projects. Pledgeship assignments may not be completed during this time.

9. Dues

- a. Each Little Sister is required to pay dues in the amount of \$150. This amount is non-refundable and must be paid in full by the seventh week of the Big Sister Little Sister process. If needed, payment plans may be arranged through the Chapter Treasurer.